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A Happy NEW YEAR
to Our
Members, Friends
and
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Best Wishes to My Many Friends and Patrons on the New Year!
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The Year In Jewish Sports

By Harold U. Ribalow

At this time of year, we weigh and judge the accomplishments of the past year, but we must not overstate or overestimate what has been done. This is a time for truth-telling. And so, in discussing the Jewish sports scene, we must point out that this has been a year of mixed blessings.

Beginning with the fine things first, we must assert that Israel's various visiting teams have made a better impression than previous squads. The basketball team that came and toured the nation performed not only adequately on the field, but particularly well in the arena of public relations. Most of the athletes had served in the Israel Army and had learned to play basketball under severe handicaps. Newspaper columnists all over the land interviewed them and stressed their intense desire to play the game well. And the coach of the team, Elmer Ripley, a non-Jew, was an eloquent expounder of the heroism of the Israeli lads. In all, this was a good trip. And the same may be said, with minor differences, of the two soccer teams—the Maccabi and the Hapoel squads—that played in the United States during the past year.

Of course there are more men on a soccer team than on a hoop quintet, so that it was possible for the basketball players to do more traveling and playing in America. Both Israeli teams did fairly well, neither of them exactly swamping their opponents. The Maccabi boys were here a longer time and made a more lasting impression. The Hapoel lads were harmed somewhat by inept public relations arranged on their behalf by American idea men. It wasn't their fault that they had to involve themselves in visits to Catholic leaders and take a back seat to Marilyn Monroe. Today, this is all past history. But it is a lesson for the future. The Next Time should be better.

Jews Scored in Olympics

Remaining on the foreign scene for a moment, Jews did fairly well in the Olympic Games, and now they are involved in the Israel Macabiah. Quite apart from the results of these games, we cannot help but be impressed by the vast number of Jewish athletes from all over the world. In reading the English-Jewish papers in Great Britain, Israel, South Africa and other lands, we constantly come across the names of Jewish stars. Quite obviously, in this Hydrogen Bomb Age, the Jew tries to compete—and often succeeds—with athletes of all other nations and faiths. He does well enough, too.

In the United States, the sports activities of Jews have been lessening in some fields and holding on in others. In boxing, for example, once a domain in which Jews excelled, there is one major personality Alphonse Halimi, who gained the bantamweight championship of the world. A predecessor was Robert Cohen. Halimi is an Algerian Jew, as was Cohen. His name is to be added to the dozens of Jewish boxing kings. Time will prove whether he is a lucky champion or one who has earned his right to the purple. In the United States there are no fighters of note, although a past champion, Barney Ross, has managed to remain in the spotlight. A film based on his career was released all over the world, and Ross has a knack for winning newspaper space with his various opinions, on boxing and on life in general.

Baseball, our national game, never did boast of many Jewish stars at a single time, even though there have been a large number of Jewish diamond stars. This past season one new star emerged. He is Sandy Koufax, the Brooklyn Dodger lefthander, whose blazing fastball made him a strikeout artist. As Koufax is only 21 years old, he has an excellent opportunity to become a major league star. Oddly enough, while there have been a few score Jewish ball stars, few indeed have won prominence as pitchers. Sandy Koufax has a chance to do that.

Another familiar name has cropped up in baseball, following years of comparative obscurity. He is Andy Cohen, who used to be a Giant second baseman in the late 1920's. Cohen has been knocking about in the minor leagues as a manager and is still doing the same sort of work. But now he is in the American Association, with Indianapolis, one of the high-ranking minors. As a result, more and more newspapermen found him good copy and quoted him on his past career, his opinion of the famous managers he knew and played under and his relationship to other players, as he was one of the first Jews to make the Big Leagues with a splash. It is not impossible that Cohen will remain in the public eye for years to come, now that he has come this far in his managerial career.

Few Jewish Stars in Basketball

Once upon a time, in the days before basketball invaded every little town and hamlet of America, the hoop sport was played mostly in the big cities. Because Jews generally settled in the larger communities, they played a comparatively major role in basketball. Today, matters are different. In professional basketball, which finally came into its own last year, there was only one Jewish star: Dolph Schayes of Syracuse, formerly of New York University. Schayes has gradually improved to the point where some basketball reporters think he is the very best in the game. In any event, he had a great year last season and remains as the only Jewish star in the pro game. While there were lots of Jewish basketball players in college ranks, the only one who won all-American mention was Lennie Rosenbluth of North Carolina. The Southern team won the mythical national championship, and Lennie was the hero of that team. In addition, North Carolina beat Kansas and the huge Wilt Chamberlain to gain the title. This, too, gave added stature to Lennie. Many of the American Yeshivas had hoop teams of better than average ability. Yeshiva University, with Red Blumen-Rodgers and Hammerstein's June reich, also won many headlines. And Blumenheich was considered well enough to be talked about as a possible professional star. We don't know whether a Yeshiva man will want to make a living playing pro ball, but the thought of his being able to do so is a tribute to his ability.

Dick Savitt in Tennis

In tennis, Dick Savitts name continues to crop up as the best of our amateurs, but it is now crystal clear that Savitt will not give up a lucrative job to hit the tournament trail any longer. As a matter of fact, he has been asked to represent the United States in its quest for the Davis Cup without entering any tournaments, but even this has become impossible for him because of his business commitments and his deep-seated feeling that he was ill-treated when he did play on the Davis Cup team. Meanwhile, Herb Flam, the only other Jewish star of stature, ranks as America's No. 2 man and plays all over the world, winning frequently. Yet it is clear that Herb doesn't have the hard-smashing game which is required in international competition for him to be able to lead our time to Davis Cup victory over the Australians.

While on the subject of international games, we must not forget that in a minor sport there occurred this past year a major upset. Mikhail Botvinnik, the world champion chess player, lost his coveted title to another Russian, Vassily Symslov. Usually, the top chess players in the world are Jews. This still holds true. But now the world title is held by a non-Jew, which has come to be accepted as remarkable. Apart from Botvinnik, other steller Jewish chess master are David Bronstein of Russia, Sammy Reshevsky of the United States and Miguel Najdorf of Argentina.

Past and Present

This writer, who conducts a weekly sports column on the subject of Jews in sports, frequently is asked where he obtains enough material to continue writing every week on the subject if fewer and fewer Jews star in various sports all over the world. The answer, of course, lies in two directions: the present and the past. The Jewish contribution to sports has been incredibly rich and varied. And to this day, there are Jewish athletes all over the world participating in scores of competitions. Many of them win national and international acclaim. And when there is a dull day, as happens in all fields, one can turn to the past, which is as comforting in sports as it is in other areas of human endeavor. In any event, sports is a continuously fascinating subject, and, we believe, will remain interesting for as long as man enjoys pitting his skill against another man.

Cultural

(Continued from page 1)

we may all be proud. By combining science, technology, money, education and spirit with will power, Israel is redeeming a land and 2 million human beings. Israel is proving something which all of Asia and Africa wants to believe: that individuals who have lived in ancient ways can skip centuries and be made into modern carpenters, plumbers, electricians, scientific farmers, engineers, musicians, teachers, and artists. Israel is proving that water can be piped hundreds of miles from its source to make deserts blossom, barren hills grow trees, machines free humans from drudgery. Its spirit can move youths to dance and sing in the streets. It is regrettable that circumstances force Israel to feel that she must put so much of her efforts into defense. But the total accomplishment is good, and Israel's culture, like blossoms, "is bustin' out all over." This can happen in Jordan, Egypt, Syria, Iran and Iraq. Knowhow, money and machines are available. All it takes in addition is real brotherhood. In Israel there is no corruption in government; the distance between the poor and the rich is righteously reasonable, kept so by honest taxation, and the people are taught a moral faith. Israel's example speaks to Asia. "If you will work and pay this price you can live well too."

Speak is the word,—peoples speaking to peoples, as equals in the sight of the Creator,—this is the opportunity and the need for all of us who will work for brotherhood across the world.

A civilization cannot live without great expectations. Our expectation that this is a new era wherein the old dangers which justified intense cultivation of destructive impulses have passed away, and now human creative capacities for understanding, love, and cooperation can be fostered. Our organization can help nations so to live that they may expect others, too, to act as members of a world family of man.

Sincerely,
EVERETT R. CLINCHY

Cordial
New Year
Greetings!

Upon this holiday occasion, we express our felicitations to the entire community. May you all be blessed with good health and an abundance of happiness, comfort and security.

We thank our many depositors and customers for their valued and loyal patronage and extend our sincere wishes for a continuance of this very pleasant relationship.

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Our Sincerest Good Wishes for a Happy and Healthful New Year to All!
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2423 W. North Ave. — Division 2-1174

In the Spirit of Old Friendship

Sincerest congratulations to Irving G. Rhodes and The Wisconsin Jewish Chronicle for their conspicuous service and devoted labors in behalf of the welfare of Jewry everywhere.

This message of friendly good wishes is respectfully tendered on the 36th Anniversary of a great newspaper.

Malcolm Woldenberg

SAZERAC CO., INC.
New Orleans, La.

EASY TO MAKE
COTTAGE CHEESE CAKE
1½ cups graham cracker crumbs, lightly packed
1¼ cups sugar
¼ cup butter, melted
4 eggs • ¼ cup flour
¼ tsp. salt
2 tbs. lemon juice
¼ tsp. lemon rind, if desired
¾ cup heavy cream
3 8-oz. packages (3 cups) Borden's Creamed Cottage Cheese, sieved
Mix crumbs and ¼ cup of sugar; blend in butter. Press mixture evenly on side and bottom of greased 8-inch spring-form pan. Beat eggs until thick; beat in remaining 1 cup sugar gradually; beat in flour and salt. Add lemon juice and rind, cream and cottage cheese; beat until well blended. Turn into pan.
Bake in slow oven (325°F) 1¼ hours. Turn off heat. Leave in closed oven 1 hour. Place on cake rack, in pan. Cool. Remove side of pan. Chill in refrigerator. (Makes 6 to 8 servings.)
Fresh as this morning's milk!
"You never run out of fresh ideas with Borden's Cottage Cheese"
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"Here's one of my favorite dessert ideas . . . a plump, golden cheese cake. So good. Lower in calories too because you bake it with fresh Borden's Cottage Cheese. Try the easy recipe."
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